

Field Trip Best Practices

The short list. Print it. Use it.

The List

- Confirm with the teacher one week before.
- Show up 15 minutes early. Every time.
- Roll out the red carpet at the door.
- Water bottles at every seat before they board.
- Safety instructions delivered with humor — they actually listen.
- Boarding song plays before they even reach the bus.
- Joke scripts matched to sport and age group.
- Music playlists ready: pre-game, we won, we lost, general.
- Offer to stop on the way back. Let them choose.
- Deboarding song. Same one every time.
- Return lost items that night. Not the next day.
- Thank you note to the teacher. Same evening. Reference something specific.

The One Rule

They are not doing you a favor by riding your bus. You are there to serve them. Every driver who figures that out raises the brand of the entire department.

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